PalmSource™ 99

20 Palm OS® Products that Don't Exist—but Should

David Pogue
"PalmPilot: The Ultimate Guide"

3Com
More connected.

How Ideas Qualify for This List

PalmSource 99

- Hasn’t been done yet (i.e., almost nothing)
- Capitalizes on exclusive features like wireless, IR, touch screen
- Exploits the fact that you always have the device with you
- Not too nichey; no simple specialized databases
- Springboard module, TRG slot, Palm III™-family “slot,” Gary Mayhak

Last Year's "Don't Exist but Should" Session: An Update

PalmSource 99

- 6 have been written
- Thousands $$$$ in cash and prizes in O'Reilly programming contest
- Quick Recap:

Pillbox Pro

- Database/alarm for prescriptions
- Pop-up menus for quick recording of instructions
- Rival: $59.95 chiming pillbox from Lillian Vernon
- Opens Palm OS™ market to vast new demographic
- Status:



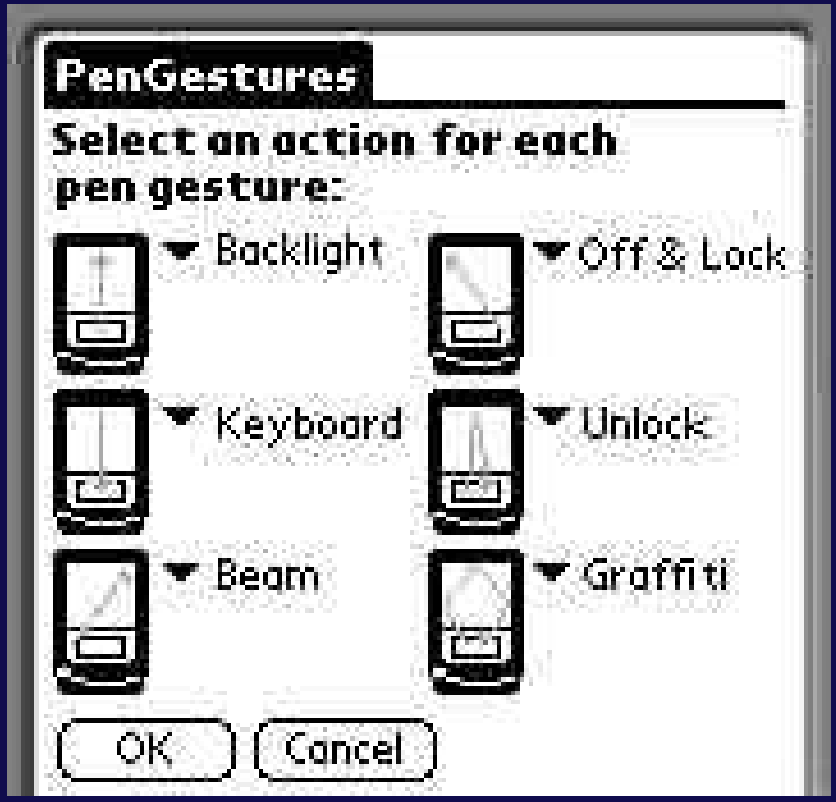
Pillbox Pro

- Status: DONE!
- PillPAL, by UFP
- Has Internet drug-interaction checks!



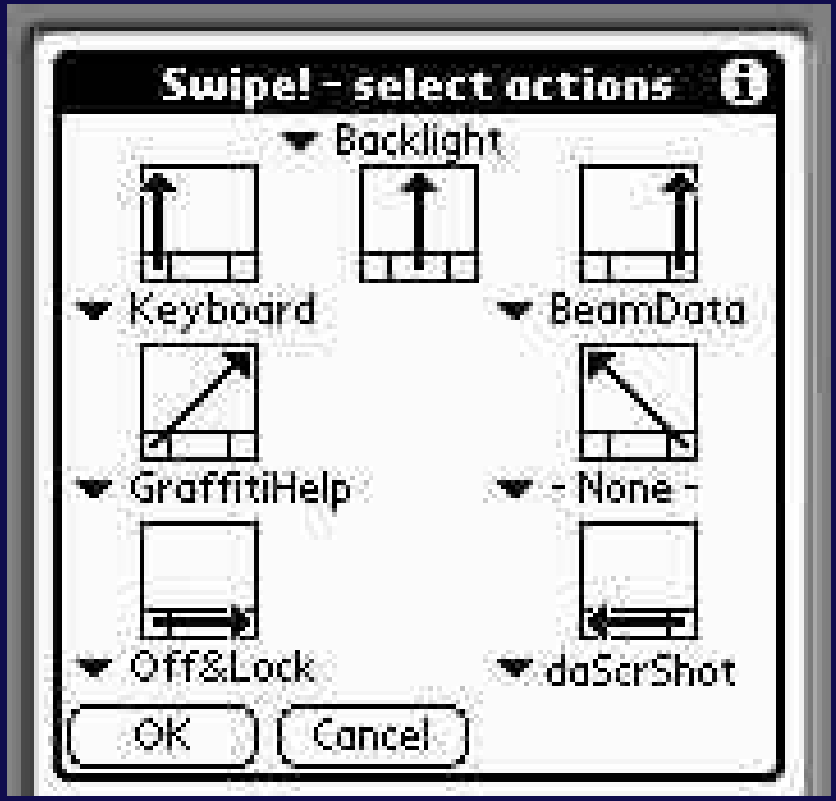
PenGestures

- Permits more “Ronomatic” strokes for common functions
- Beam, backlight, shut off, VII check and send mail, etc.



PenGestures

- Status: DONE!
- Swipe, by DoubleBang
- Can also launch “desk accessories” with a stroke
- Won O’Reilly Programming Contest “Pogue Prize”



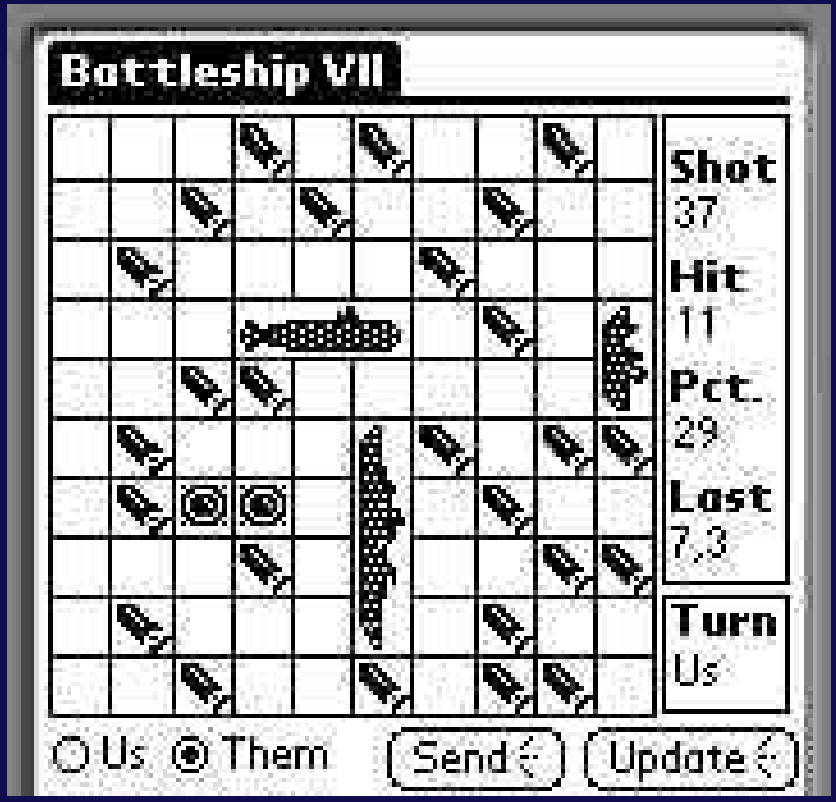
iMailer

- Adds filtering, forwarding, and excerpted replies to iMessenger
- Permits message transfer between iMessenger and Palm Mail (and from there to desktop)
- Status: STILL AVAILABLE



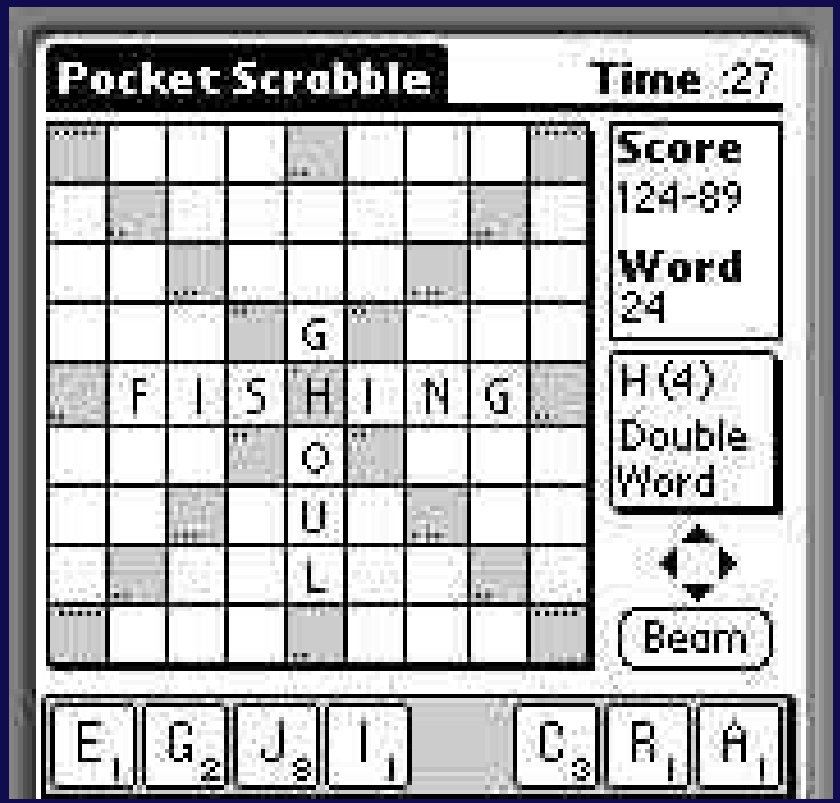
Battleship VII

- Wireless—play your pal in Chicago
- Other wireless games:
  - Chess VII
  - Checkers VII
  - Hangman VII
- Modeled on existing IR games
- Status: STILL AVAILABLE



IR Scrabble

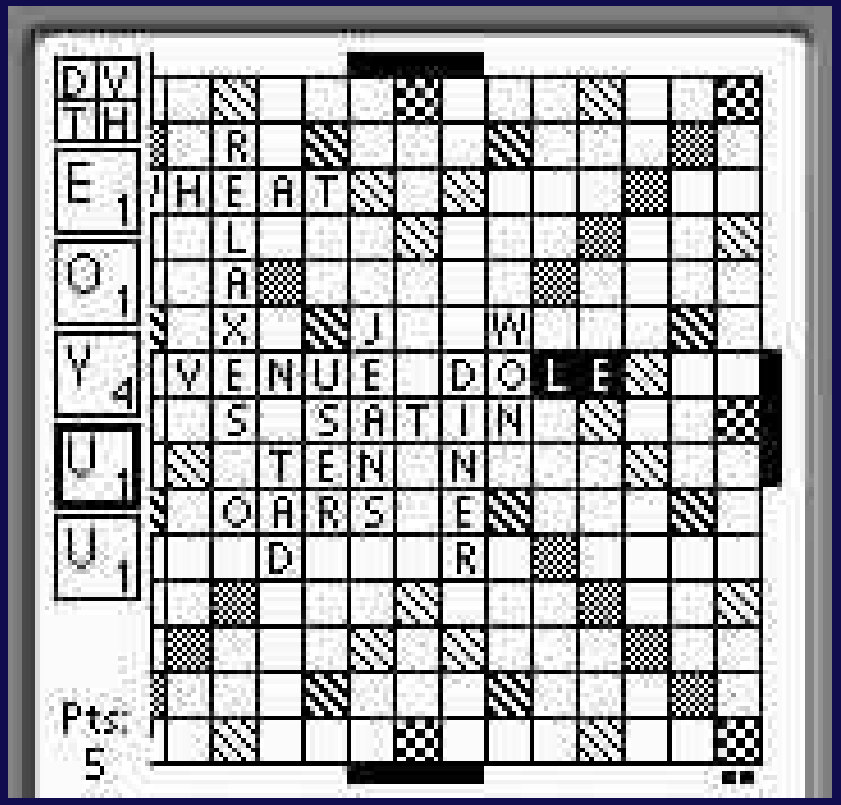
- Problem with PC versions: They see your letters!
- Drag to place letters
- Tap to identify special squares
- Auto-scoring, auto-timer
- Wireless Scrabble VII, too



Scrabble VII

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- Status: DONE
- Crosswords 2.0, by Eric House and Ariela H.
  - (But no infrared yet)



Whiteboard

- Infrared or wireless
- Sketches, text, ideas, Tic-Tac-Toe
- Use on plane, train, or automobile
- Insta-meeting
- Kids in the back seat



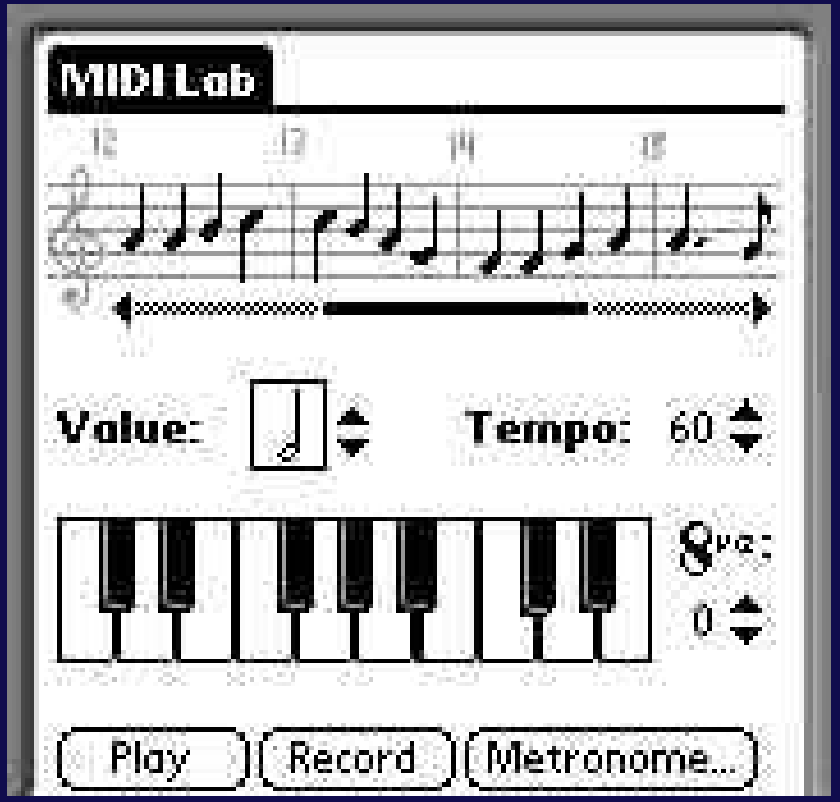
Whiteboard

- Status: DONE!
- IRP2PChat, by IS Complete
- Also has typed chat by IR



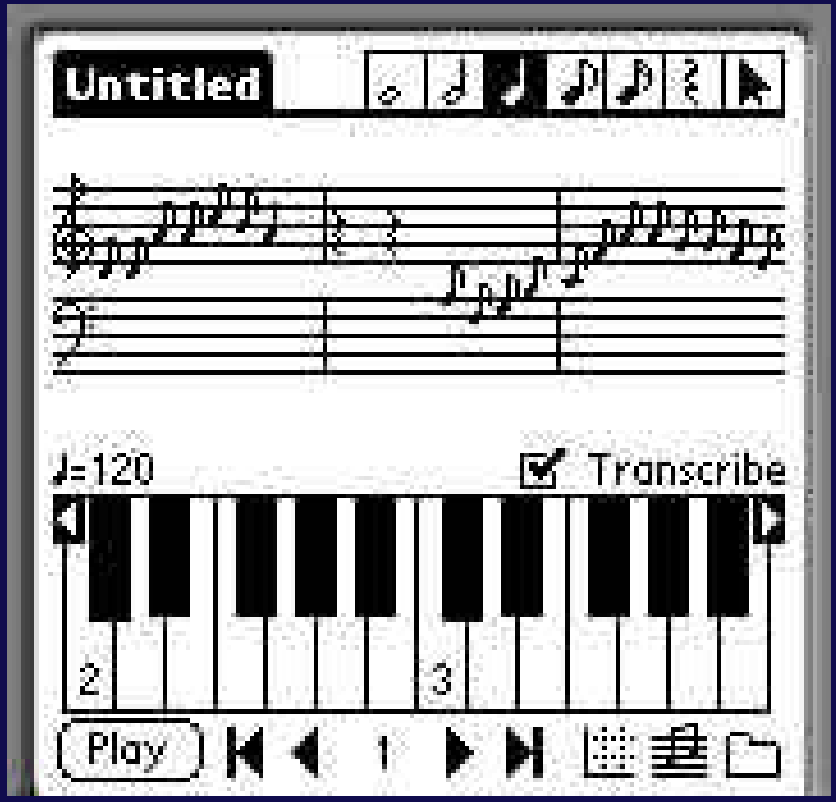
MIDI Lab

- Reads and saves standard MIDI files
- Basic sheet-music view
- Pop-up menu of notes and rests
- Metronome record
- Save songs as alarms for Date Book app



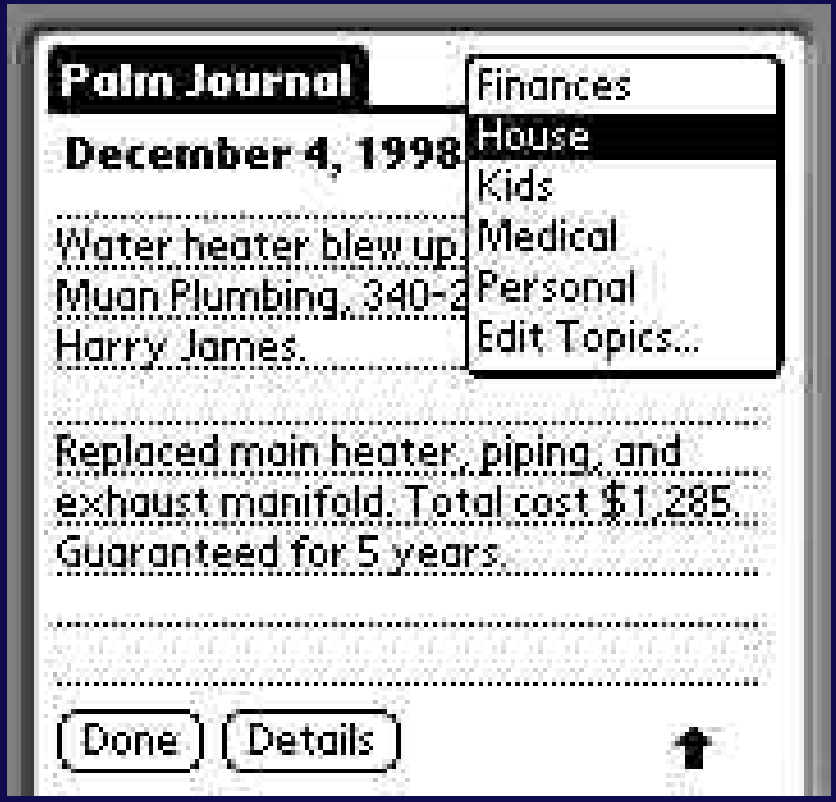
MIDI Lab

- Status: DONE!
- MiniMusic, by Chad Mealey
- Even outputs to MIDI via HotSync® port



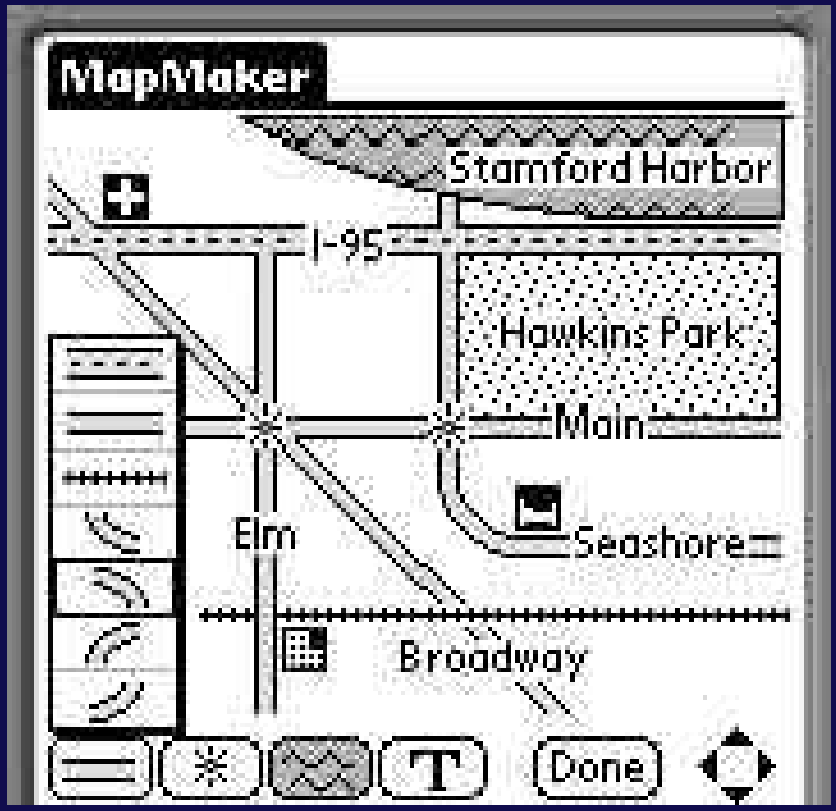
PalmJournal

- Categories
  - Financial events
  - House Repair
  - Warranties
  - Medical events
  - Kids
- Auto-mark anniversaries
- Status: DONE (as new event type in the Handspring Date Book; also Palm Journal)



MapMaker

- Pop-ups for:
  - Roads/tracks
  - Symbols (lights, buildings)
  - Areas (woods, water)
  - Text
- Scrolling virtual page
- Status: STILL AVAILABLE



What's the Score?

- Tap anywhere to increment score
- Scores tennis, ping-pong, golf, shuffleboard, etc.
- Count events (party guests entering, cars at intersection, "quite franklies" in PalmSource keynotes, etc.)
- Status: STILL AVAILABLE!



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10 More Apps That Don't Exist…but Should

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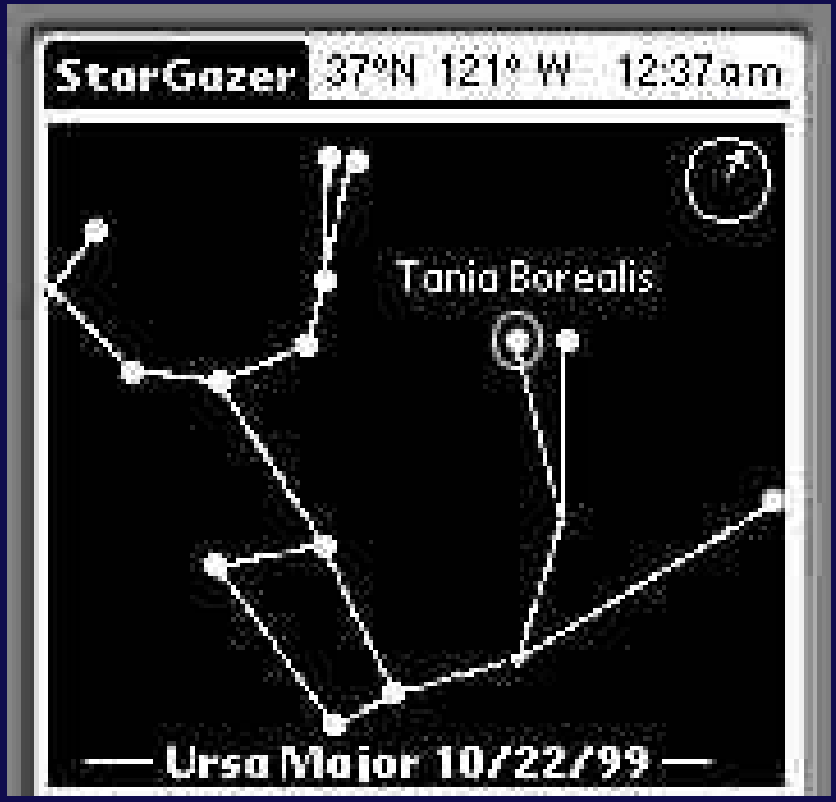
Tipster

- Like QuickTip and its ilk, but not just for restaurants
- Suggests customary amounts for various tipping situations
- Not just a calculator; also an etiquette coach
- Use slider to indicate quality of service
- Prefs let you specify cab rates in your city



StarGazer

- Your nighttime cosmic companion
- Specify your location; it already knows the time
- Drag compass to indicate heading
- Match the diagram with the sky (backlight helps)
- Tap a star to see its name and constellation; double-tap for more info
- Scroll buttons to zoom



Wine Spectator VII

- A Palm VII™ PQA that's dying to be written
- Can't impress her with wine smarts? Blow her away with technology
- Perfect for restaurant or liquor-store use



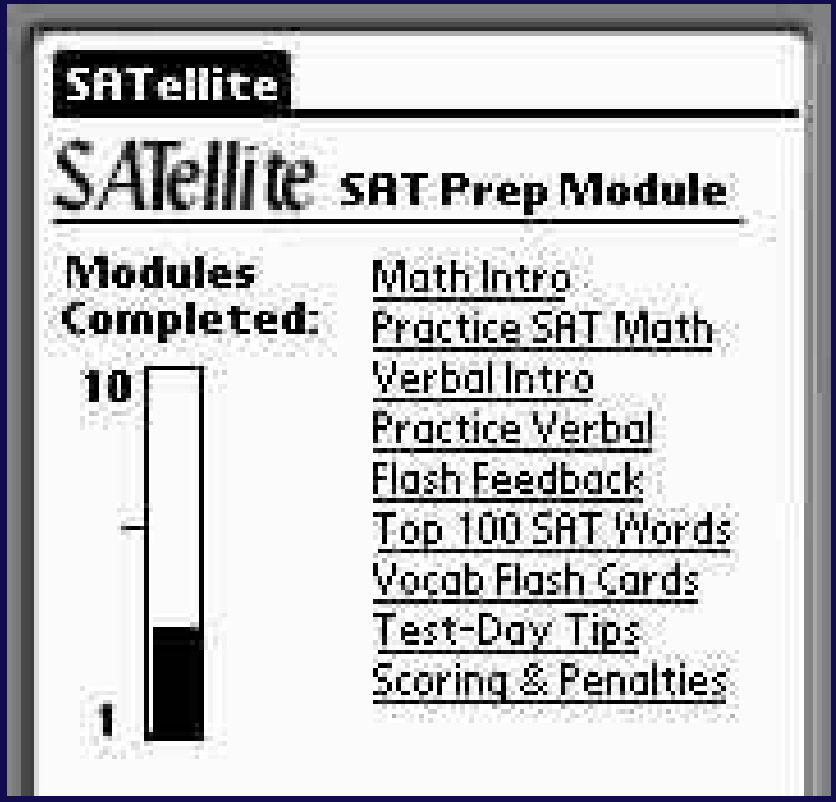
Wine Spectator VII

- Returns blurb and stats
- Symbol version: Scans bar-code on bottle before retrieving data from the Net



SATellite SAT Prep

- Catch the wave of low-cost Palm OS™ devices entering high-school market
- Analogy tests, flash cards, mock exams
- Palm portability means kids can study anywhere
- (JH also suggests: Graphing Apps, Language modules)



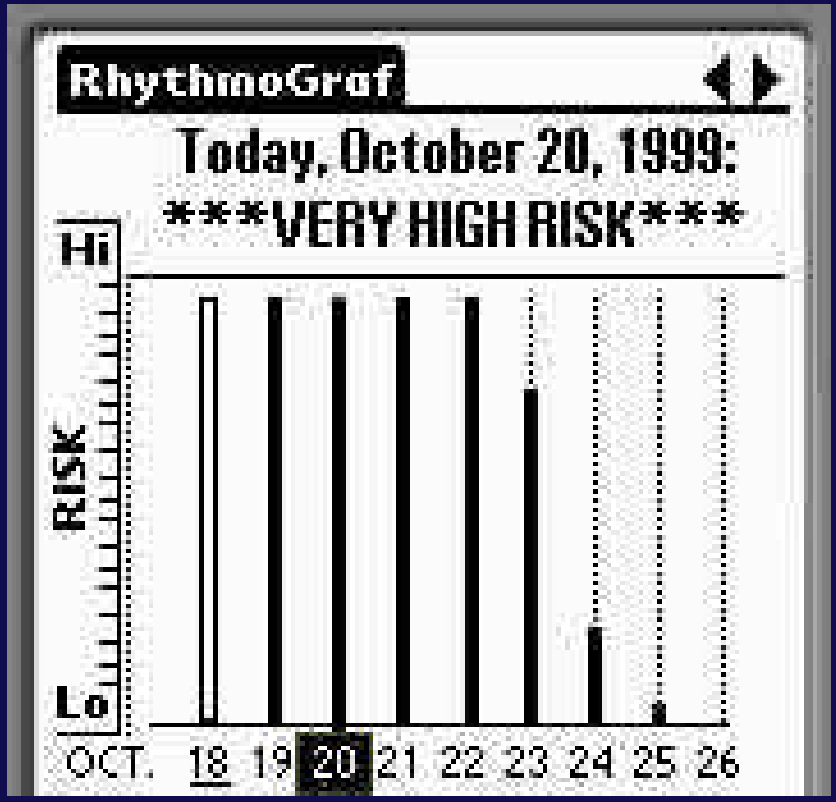
GEDCOM Generator

- GEDCOM: a standard genealogy-data exchange format
- Palm OS® devices: Ideal note-takers during interviews, library visits, Dept. of Records stops, etc.
- Why re-copy your findings back to the PC? HotSync® technology already exists



Rhythmometer

- "In ideal circumstances, the rhythm method could be very effective (92%). Nonetheless, this requires training and adherence to the guidelines of the rhythm method, which does not always occur. For typical users the rhythm method is less than 87% effective."
  –*Sexual Health InfoCenter*
- O-day indicated
- Companion app: Fertility Grapher



ClickTVCR

- Merges four great technologies:
  - ClickTV.com
  - OmniRemote
  - VCR Plus
  - Palm VII™ (AvantGo-style cradle method also available)
- Download what's on now, or tonight
- One tap sets VCR to record your fave



Airport Outlet Finder

- Tap the airport, see where you plug in your laptop between flights
- Palm VII version: Updated frequently, no limit to database size
- Visor version: Comes on a module, size no problem
- Palm family: Loads only 1 country's worth of airports



IronMan

- The stylus is the “magnet pen”
- Little bitmapped “filings”
- Choice of faces via menu or scroll button
- Who’d pay money for this thing?
- Take a 3-year-old on a plane ride and you’ll know



NaturallySpeaking for the Palm Computing® Platform

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- A totally bogus app, like ThumbScan or Tricorder
- Yet devastatingly convincing to the layman
- Types out a canned phrase as you speak it
- Learn useful lessons in the manipulation of your fellow man
- Make Windows CE look primitive



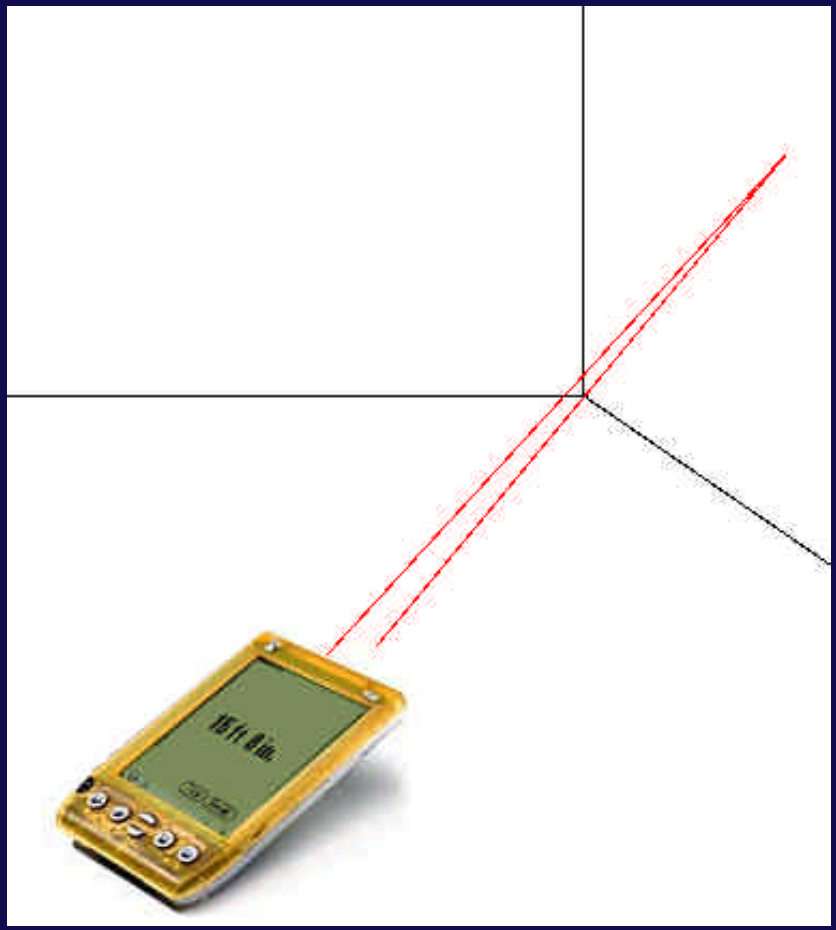
PalmSource™ 99

10 Hardware Products that Don't Exist…but Should

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Carpenter Mate

- Springboard module (Handspring) or serial-port add-on (Palm)
- Two functions:
  - IR tape measure (add-on IR power module built in)
  - Stud finder
- Built-in calculators, load tables, and other software



TakeCharge™

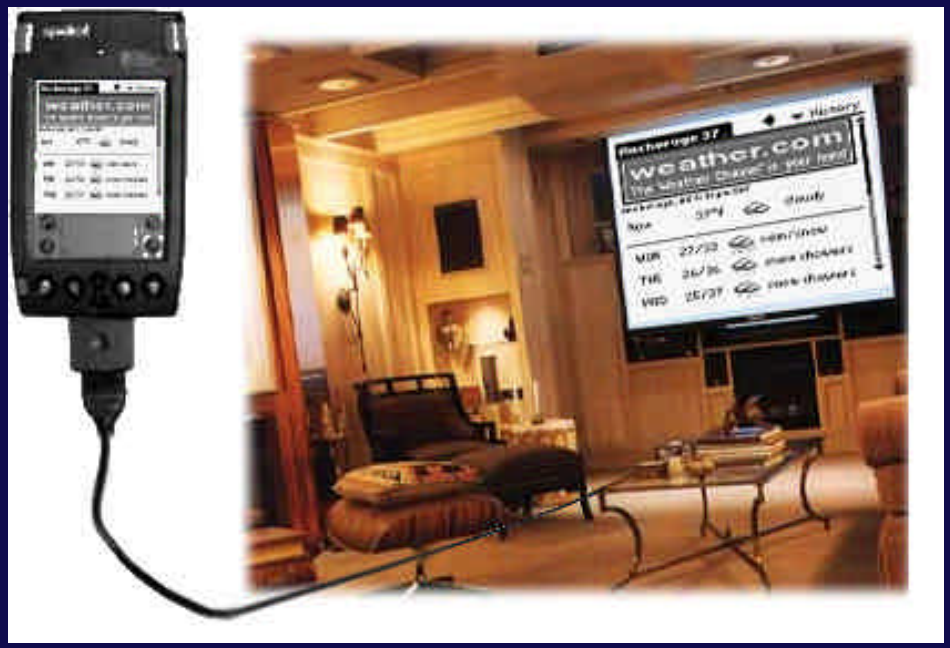
- The inexpensive battery tester for homes and pros
- Attachments for standard and 9V terminals
- Pop-up menu to specify battery type



Presenter for the Palm Computing® Platform

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- Video-out
- Springboard module, or clip-on for Palm devices
- Brilliant for training, demos, teleprompting, movies, TV, Web downloadable app demos
- Provides standard RCA or VGA jacks at end of cable



Breathalizer

- The technology is out there:
- "Microminiaturization of gas sensors could literally put a breathalizer on a chip in the next couple of years. They would cost only a few dollars. CSS Microelectronics group already has a working alcohol sensor that is only 4mm square."
  –The Centre For Systems Science
- For personal or professional use
- The radar-detector syndrome (self-policing)



TherModular

- The module for parents, doctors, couples
- Software in module graphs temps over time
- Tracks different children
- (Donna's idea)



Squeeze Charger

- 30 seconds of hand-squeezing fills capacitors for 30 minutes
- Ideal for hikers, bikers, National Geographic employees
- For non-Palm V™ models: a snap-in power pack that replaces your dead batteries
- Also: Solar Charger!



PalmScan

- The pocket OCR solution
- Displaces $250 Sharper Image-type doodads
- Far more useful than standalone gizmos: text-to-PC mechanism already familiar
- Can correct errors in the field



PockOdometer

- Clip-on module (or Springboard module) senses strides
- Software provides real-time statistics as you run
- Miles, time, calories burned
- Software tracks progress over time



A USB Cradle

- Yes, Handspring has one, but Palm's own customer base= 5,000,000+
- Macintosh alone: 4,000,000 sold annually, USB only
- Could probably produce it for the price of a USB adapter alone



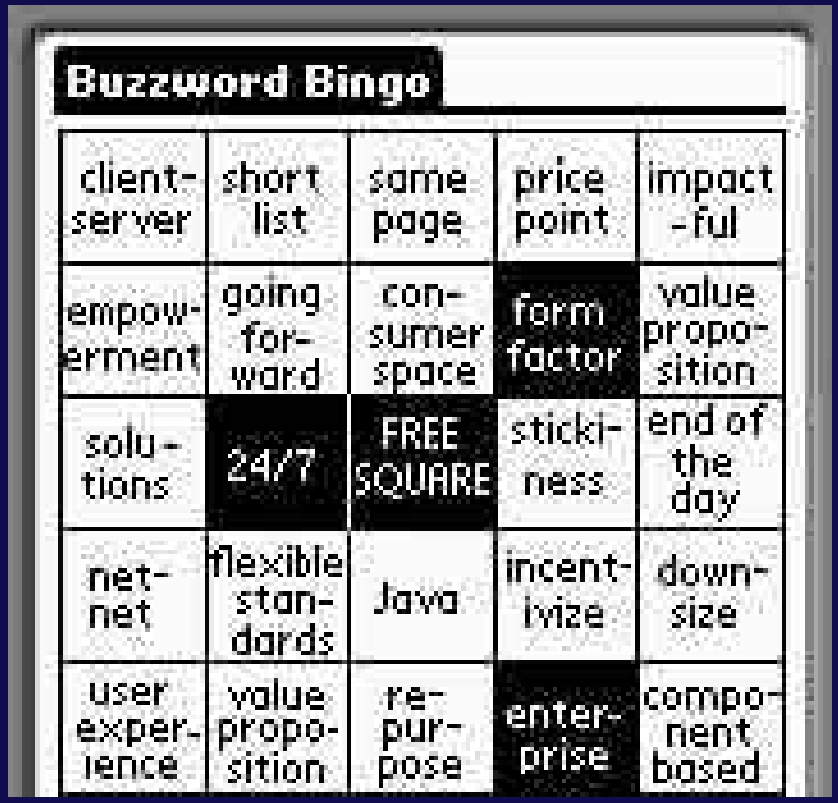
David Pogue

PalmSource 99

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Buzzword Bingo

- The riotous free-for-all game that's sweeping corporate America!
- Make tedious meetings fly by
- Ideal for trade shows, speeches, and developer conferences
- Look like you're just taking notes



Real Buzzword Bingo (oops)

- By Christopher Cotton
- Imports buzzword lists from Memo Pad

solutions	price point	incentivize	user experience	net net
going forward	24/7	enterprise	mission critical	form factor
client-server	solutions	Free space	incentivize	user experience
net net	going forward	24/7	enterprise	mission critical
form factor	client-server	solutions	price point	incentivize

eBay Tracker

- Real-time updates for the eBay addict
- Palm VII: checks wirelessly on request…
- Palm V: Checks via HotSync cradle at scheduled intervals (thanks to desktop component)
- Both buyers and sellers






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